



English AI
Local Coach

ENGLISH AI · THEORY LESSON

Public Transportation & Getting Around

Vocabulary, useful phrases, grammar, writing and conversation practice

Level A2-B1 · 45-60 min · Lesson 08

LESSON GOAL

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to ask for directions, understand basic route instructions, buy or validate a ticket, talk about buses and trains, and solve common transportation problems.

Study the transport vocabulary and route language first. Then practise direction sequences and questions. Finish with the Conversation Lab by navigating an unfamiliar city from one place to another.

Communication goal

When you are lost, short and specific questions work best. Ask one thing at a time, repeat the key information, and confirm the final stop or direction.

[START HERE](#)

Lesson map

A simple sequence: learn the key language, practise the structure, and then use it in a realistic conversation.

01

LEARN

Vocabulary + useful chunks

02

BUILD

Grammar + model dialogue

03

SPEAK

Writing + role-play

Warm-up

1. How do you usually get around your city?
2. Which is easier for you: bus, subway, train, or driving? Why?
3. Have you ever gotten lost in another city?
4. What transportation words do you already know in English?

Before you continue

Answer the four questions in English using short sentences. Do not worry about mistakes yet. The goal is to activate the topic before studying the new language.



VOCABULARY 01

Essential vocabulary

Study the meaning and then read each example aloud. Try to connect each word to a real situation from your own life.

WORD / PHRASE	MEANING	EXAMPLE
bus stop	ponto de ônibus	The bus stop is across the street.
station	estação	Meet me at the train station.
platform	plataforma	The train leaves from platform 4.
line	linha	Take the blue line.
route	rota	This route goes downtown.
fare	tarifa	The fare is two dollars.
ticket machine	máquina de bilhetes	You can buy a ticket at the machine.
one-way ticket	bilhete só de ida	I need a one-way ticket.
round trip	ida e volta	A round-trip ticket is cheaper.
transfer	baldeação / conexão	You need to transfer at Central Station.
stop	parada	Get off at the next stop.
intersection	cruzamento	Turn left at the intersection.
crosswalk	faixa de pedestres	Use the crosswalk.
traffic	trânsito	Traffic is heavy this morning.
delay	atraso	The train has a ten-minute delay.
destination	destino	What is your final destination?



VOCABULARY 02

Movement and route expressions

These combinations are more useful than isolated words because directions are usually given as a sequence of actions.

EXPRESSION	MEANING	EXAMPLE / USE
get on	entrar no ônibus/trem	Get on the number 12 bus.
get off	descer	Get off at Market Street.
take the subway	pegar o metrô	Take the subway to downtown.
change lines	trocar de linha	Change lines at Central.
go straight	seguir reto	Go straight for two blocks.
turn left / right	virar à esquerda / direita	Turn right after the bank.
cross the street	atravessar a rua	Cross the street at the light.
walk past	passar por	Walk past the pharmacy.
next to	ao lado de	The station is next to the mall.
across from	em frente a	The stop is across from the hotel.
how long does it take?	quanto tempo leva?	How long does it take by bus?
which stop?	qual parada?	Which stop should I get off at?

Study tip

Learn complete expressions, not only isolated words. In conversation, retrieving a ready-made chunk is much faster than building every sentence from zero.



USEFUL PHRASES

What to say in real situations

These phrases are designed to be spoken. Read them aloud and imagine the exact situation where you would use each one.

SITUATION	PHRASE	USE / MEANING
Directions	Excuse me, how do I get to...?	Ask for a route.
	Is it within walking distance?	Ask if you can walk.
	Am I going the right way?	Confirm direction.
Tickets	Where can I buy a ticket?	Find the sales point.
	Can I pay by card?	Ask about payment.
	Do I need to validate this ticket?	Check ticket rules.
On the route	Which line should I take?	Choose a line.
	Where do I need to change?	Ask about transfers.
	Could you tell me when we get to...?	Ask someone to alert you.
Problems	Is this train delayed?	Check a delay.
	I think I missed my stop.	Explain a mistake.
	What is the fastest way to get there now?	Find an alternative.

Make it yours

Choose three phrases from this page and rewrite them with details from your own life. Personal examples are easier to remember and use naturally.

GRAMMAR FOCUS

Imperatives + prepositions for directions

Directions often use the imperative: start with the verb and omit the subject. Prepositions and landmarks tell the listener where to move or where something is located.

PATTERN	EXAMPLE	USE
Imperative	Go straight for two blocks.	instruction
Imperative	Turn left at the traffic light.	instruction
at	Get off at Central Station.	specific point / stop
next to	The station is next to the museum.	beside
across from	The bus stop is across from the bank.	opposite side

Direction formula

ACTION + LANDMARK / DISTANCE. “Go straight for two blocks, turn right at the bank, and the station is next to the supermarket.”

Mini practice

Complete: Turn right _____ the traffic light.

Choose: The station is next to / next the museum.

Write an imperative with “go straight”.

Give two steps from your home to a nearby place.

MODEL DIALOGUE

Finding the right subway route

Notice how the traveler confirms the line, transfer point, and final stop instead of trying to remember everything at once.

TRAVELER Excuse me, how do I get to the City Museum from here?

LOCAL The easiest way is by subway. Take the green line toward North Park.

TRAVELER Okay. Do I need to change lines?

LOCAL Yes. Change to the red line at Central Station.

TRAVELER Which stop should I get off at?

LOCAL Get off at Museum Square. It is the second stop after Central.

TRAVELER Is the museum close to the station?

LOCAL Yes. When you leave the station, turn left and walk straight for about three minutes.

TRAVELER Can I use the same ticket for both lines?

LOCAL Yes, as long as you do not leave the system.

TRAVELER Great. So green line, change at Central, then red line to Museum Square?

LOCAL Exactly. You have got it.

Confirm key information

Repeat the route in your own words: line -> transfer -> final stop. This prevents many travel mistakes.

WRITING PRACTICE 01

Build useful sentences

Translate the sentences into English using the vocabulary and structures from this lesson. More than one answer may be correct.

1. Onde fica o ponto de ônibus mais próximo?
2. Qual linha eu devo pegar?
3. Onde eu preciso fazer baldeação?
4. Desça na próxima parada.
5. Siga reto por dois quarteirões.
6. Vire à esquerda no semáforo.
7. A estação fica em frente ao banco.
8. Quanto tempo leva de metrô?
9. Posso pagar o bilhete com cartão?
10. Acho que perdi a minha parada.
11. Este trem está atrasado?
12. Qual é a maneira mais rápida de chegar lá?

WRITING PRACTICE 02

Write step-by-step directions

Clear directions are short, ordered, and based on visible landmarks whenever possible.

Task: Write 90-120 words explaining how to travel from your home, university, or hotel to a familiar destination. Include at least five route actions, one transportation method, one landmark, and an estimate of travel time.

Try to include some of these:

- First, take...
- Get on at...
- Get off at...
- Then, change to...
- Go straight...
- Turn left / right at...
- It is next to / across from...
- It takes about...

Simple structure

START -> TRANSPORT -> TRANSFER / LANDMARKS -> FINAL WALK. Use sequence words so the route is easy to follow.

Self-check before you finish

- ☐ Did I clearly identify the starting point?
- ☐ Are the instructions in the correct order?
- ☐ Did I include the stop or station names?
- ☐ Could a stranger follow these directions?

CONVERSATION PRACTICE

Role-plays for the AI coach

Open the Conversation Lab and complete each situation before asking the AI to correct you. Try to stay in English even when you need time to think.

Role-play 1 · Lost tourist

You are in an unfamiliar city. Ask the AI how to reach a museum using public transportation. Confirm the line, transfer, stop, and walking directions.

Role-play 2 · Ticket problem

The ticket machine is confusing. Ask the AI, acting as station staff, which ticket you need, how much it costs, and whether you need to validate it.

Role-play 3 · Service disruption

Your train is delayed and you have an appointment. Ask the AI for another route and compare two options by time and number of transfers.

Questions to practise

- How do I get to...?
- Which line should I take?
- Where do I change lines?
- Which stop should I get off at?
- How long does it take?
- Is it within walking distance?
- Can I use the same ticket?
- Is there a faster route?

REVIEW

Mini test

Complete this without looking back. The goal is to see what you can produce from memory, not only what you recognize on the page.

1. Translate: plataforma = _____
2. Translate: baldeação = _____
3. Translate: tarifa = _____
4. Complete: Get _____ at the next stop.
5. Complete: Turn left _____ the bank.
6. Write a phrase meaning “em frente a”.
7. Translate: “Qual linha eu devo pegar?”
8. Translate: “A estação fica ao lado do museu.”
9. Ask how long the trip takes.
10. Ask where to change lines.
11. Give one instruction with “go straight”.
12. Give one instruction with “turn right”.
13. Ask if you can pay by card.
14. Explain that you missed your stop.
15. Repeat this route naturally: blue line -> Central -> red line -> Park Street.

ANSWER KEY

Check and learn from your mistakes

Some answers can vary. The versions below are natural examples using the language taught in this lesson.

Grammar mini practice

- at
- next to
- Example: Go straight for three blocks.
- Answers vary.

Writing practice 01 - Suggested answers

1. Where is the nearest bus stop?
2. Which line should I take?
3. Where do I need to transfer?
4. Get off at the next stop.
5. Go straight for two blocks.
6. Turn left at the traffic light.
7. The station is across from the bank.
8. How long does it take by subway?
9. Can I pay for the ticket by card?
10. I think I missed my stop.
11. Is this train delayed?
12. What is the fastest way to get there?

Review strategy

Mark the sentences that felt slow or uncertain. Say those sentences aloud three times, then create one new example with the same structure.

FINISH

Mini test answers + progress check

Use the score only as a guide. The real objective is to understand the topic and communicate without stopping every time you need a new sentence.

1. platform
2. transfer
3. fare
4. off
5. at
6. across from
7. Which line should I take?
8. The station is next to the museum.
9. How long does it take?
10. Where do I need to change lines?
- 11-15. Answers vary; use the route structures from the lesson.

READY FOR CONVERSATION?

If you can do these four things, move to the Conversation Lab.

- ✓ Ask for and understand basic directions.
- ✓ Use get on, get off, transfer, and route vocabulary.
- ✓ Give ordered directions with landmarks.
- ✓ Handle a ticket or delay problem politely.

Next lesson suggestion: Renting an Apartment & Housing